

inflationary ("Political Threat to Growth", December 21). But it is not just faulty planning, black marketers and hoarders are as much a part of inflation. And so are the unwanted intermediaries who add on to their margins heavily. They make a good profit in short-run but in the long-run they suffer too as basic cost of raw material goes up and cost of production increases at every step.

MAHESH KUMAR

via www.indiatoday.in

Choppy Waters

The decision to buy high-cost helicopters from an Italian company for the use of ministers and vVIPs is a nasty blow to austerity measures and questions the credibility of the UPA ("Austerity Choppers", December 21). One can only hope that the Government will closely look at the quotation of the company and follow the norms lest it becomes another Bofors-like issue, which has become non-existent after spending crores of taxpayer money to unearth the truth.

K.R. SRINIVASAN,

Secunderabad

Polluted Purity

Restricting the visitors around Gaumukh is as much the need of the hour as is clearing the garbage in the area ("Ban Aid for the Ganga", December 14). Taking cue from the

Uttarakhand chief minister, all other chief ministers should also ensure that cleaning of the Ganga is done very meticulously. India's holiest river is still in a polluted state in almost all the areas through which it flows.

LT-COL RANJIT SINHA (RETD),

Kochi

Graft Monster

Apart from the big threats of terrorism, Naxalism,

Fourth Estate has ceased to be a watchdog, with rather rare exceptions. Money and muscle power drive our elections, even as Parliament's effectiveness stands compromised.

N.A. SARMA, Hyderabad

Corrigendum

In the story, "Running Out of Steam", November 23, 2009, we wrote about how Suresh Raina had played more than 80 ODIs.

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR/www.indiatodayimages.com



It is indeed regretful that active political leaders race to chair cricket bodies at national and state levels, due to which their greater responsibility towards governance and voters clearly stand ignored.

MADHU AGARWAL, Delhi

Pakistan and China, there is another one that looms large over India and is no less serious than others—corruption ("The Big Threats", November 9). By and large, the Government ignores it because it is the government institutions and personnel who mainly indulge in it, while people suffer. Even the

This was mentioned in the graphic caption and the text stated: "Suresh Raina, who until the seventh ODI had played 85 ODIs..." At the time of writing, he had completed his 77th ODI for India and had played 87 international matches, including ODIs and T20s. The error is regretted.

EDITOR

A Sick Economy

Six weeks after Mrs Gandhi's new government took over—"A government that works"—there are no signs that it means to push back the tide of dissipation that apparently overtook the country's economy and polity during the Janata regime. Whatever the Janata Government's policies that were responsible for such a disastrous state of affairs, the new government has done little so far to change them. All that has happened is that there have been changes in the Planning Commission, ministers have been saddled with a multiplicity of key portfolios, and the administration is apparently in no hurry to present its budget until it has won its political skirmishes in the states, which means that the current stalemate on the economic front will continue well into the summer and possibly beyond. What is worse, government spokesmen—even those who do not hold official positions—have been told to keep their mouths shut. "My lips are sealed," says a high-ranking ruling party member of Parliament whose name features at the head of the next likely batch of members. In the meantime, things are going from bad to worse, if they are going at all.

by Jay Dubashi

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